3. **There is no known safe level of exposure to mercury.**

How many of the above statements are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

Ans. (c) : Mercury is used in mining of Gold thus a source of pollution. Statement 1 is correct.
Coal based Thermal power plants are major source of mercury. Thus statement 2 is correct.
Mercury is a highly toxic element, there is no safe level of exposure. Thus statement 3 is also correct.

90. With reference to green hydrogen, consider the following statements :
1. **It can be used directly as a fuel for internal combustion.**
2. **It can be blended with natural gas and used as fuel for heat or power generation.**
3. **It can be used in the hydrogen fuel cell to run vehicles.**

How many of the above statements are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

Ans. (c) : Both hydrogen internal combustion engines and hydrogen fuel cell can power vehicles using hydrogen. Hydrogen engines burn hydrogen in an internal combustion engine. Thus statement I is correct.
Hydrogen can be blended with natural gas and can be used as fuel with lower emission. Thus statement II is correct.
Fuel cell electric vehicles are powered by hydrogen. They are more efficient than internal combustion engine. Thus statement III is correct.

91. Consider the following statements with reference to India :
1. **According to the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (MSMED) Act, 2006', the 'medium enterprises' are those with investments in plant and machinery between ₹ 15 crore and ₹ 25 crore.**
2. **All bank loans to the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises qualify under the priority sector.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d) : As per the MSMED Act 2006, the Medium Enterprises are those for which the investment in plant and machinery is not more than Rs. 50 crore and turnovers not more than Rs. 250 crore. Thus statement I is incorrect.
According to RBI's All bank loans to MSMEs that meet the criteria outlined in the Master Direction on Priority Sector Lending (PSL) targets and classification are only eligible to classify as PSL. Thus statement II is incorrect.

92. With reference to Central Bank digital currencies, consider the following statements :
1. **It is possible to make payments in a digital currency without using US dollar or SWIFT systems.**
2. **A digital currency can be distributed with a condition programmed into it such as a time-frame for spending it.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) : It is possible to make payments in digital currencies without using US dollar or SWIFT system. Hence Statement I is correct. The digital Yuan is programmable to the extent that the currency can be designed to expire, forcing users to spend it all by a specific date. It means that the digital currencies can be programmed to be spent within a predetermined time range. Hence Statement II is correct.

93. In the context of finance, the term 'beta' refers to
(a) the process of simultaneous buying and selling of an asset from different platforms
(b) an investment strategy of a portfolio manager to balance risk versus reward
(c) a type of systemic risk that arises where perfect hedging is not possible
(d) a numeric value that measures that fluctuations of a stock to changes in the overall stock market.

Ans. (d) : Beta is a concept by which a stock's expected movement in relation to overall market movements is measured. A stock with a beta greater than is considered to be more volatile than the broader market while the stock with Beta less than 1 is considered to be less volatile.

94. Consider the following statements :
1. **The Self-Help Group (SHG) programme was originally initiated by the State Bank of India by providing microcredit to the financially deprived.**
2. **In an SHG, all members of a group take responsibility for a loan that an individual member takes.**
3. **The Regional Rural Banks and Scheduled Commercial Banks support SHGs.**

How many of the above statements are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

Ans. (b) : NABARD began promoting SHG's in 1991-1992 and it served as the launch pad for SHG movement. Hence Statement I is incorrect.
The banks provide the loan to SHG as a whole and it is the collective responsibility of the SHG to repay that loan. Hence all members of a group take responsibility for a loan that an individual member takes. Hence Statement II is correct.
Both SCB's and RRB's support the SHG. Hence Statement III is correct.
Thus option (b) is correct.

95. Consider the following statements :
Statement-I : India's public sector health care system largely focuses on curative care with limited preventive, promotive and rehabilitative care.
Statement II : Under India's decentralized approach to health care delivery, the States are primarily responsible for organizing health services.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements :
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is the correct explanation for Statement-I.
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is not the correct explanation for Statement-I.
(c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect.
(d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct.

Ans. (b) : As per the National Health Policy 2017. India's Public Sector health core system focuses on improving health status through coordinated police action in all sectors. It also focuses on expanding preventive promotive, curative, palliative and rehabilitative service through public health sector which focuses on quality of these services.
The states are primarily incharge of organising health services under India's decentralised system for providing healthcare. 'Health and Sanitation' is in states list under schedule 7 of the constitution.
Thus Statement I and Statement II both are correct however statement II does not explain statement I.

96. Consider the following statements :
Statement-I : According to the United Nations World Water Development Report, 2022, India extracts more than a quarter of the world's groundwater withdrawal each year.
Statement II : India needs to extract more than a quarter of the world's groundwater each year to satisfy the drinking water and sanitation needs of almost 18% of world's population living in its territory.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements :
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is the correct explanation for Statement-I.
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is not the correct explanation for Statement-I.
(c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect.
(d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct.

Ans. (c) : According to United Nations World Water Development Report 2022, India is world's largest groundwater user. This accounts for more than a quarter of the total ground water extracted internationally.
India uses 89% of extracted ground water for irrigation. Thus major share of extracted groundwater is used in irrigation and not for drinking and sanitation purpose.
Thus Statement I is correct and Statement II is incorrect.

97. Consider the following statements :
1. **According to the Constitution of India, the Central Government has a duty to protect States from internal disturbances.**
2. **The Constitution of India exempts the States from providing legal counsel to a person being held for preventive detention.**
3. **According to the Prevention of Terrorism Act, 2002, confession of the accused before the police cannot be used as evidence.**

How many of the above statements are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

Ans. (b) : Article 355 of the constitution provides for the responsibility of Union to protect states from external aggression and internal disturbance.
Article 22 of constitution of India exempts the states from providing legal counsel to a person being held for preventive detention.
As per Section 32(1) of POTA, 2002, Confession of the accused before a police officer not lower in rank than a Superintendent of police can be used as evidence.
Thus statements 1 and 2 are correct and statement 3 is incorrect.

98. Which one of the following countries has been suffering from decades of civil strife and food shortages and was in news in the recent past for its very severe famine?
(a) Angola (b) Costa Rica (c) Ecuador (d) Somalia

Ans. (d) : In Somalia 6.5 million people are currently facing Severe Food insecurity amid the driest condition in 40 years after is consecutive failed rainy seasons.
Also there was a civil strife of three decades in Somalia.

99. Consider the following statements :
1. **In India, the Biodiversity Management Committees are key to the realization of the objectives of the Nagoya Protocol.**
2. **The Biodiversity Management Committees have important functions in determining access and benefit sharing, including the power to levy collection fees on the access of biological resources within its jurisdiction.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) : Nagoya protocol aims to equitable share the benefits resulting from the use of genetic resources. According to Biological Diversity Act 2002, every local body in the state shall establish a Biodiversity Management Committee within its area of jurisdiction for the purpose of promoting biological diversity conservation, sustainable use, and documentation. In India, the BHC's functions as the agency for the implementations of the objectives of Nagoya Protocol.
The Biodiversity Act gives BHC's the independent authority to charge those who collect biological resources within their territorial jurisdiction by way of collection of fees.

100. Consider the following statements in respect of election to the President of India :
1. **The members nominated to either House of the Parliament or the Legislative Assemblies of States are also eligible to the included in the Electoral College.**
2. **Higher the number of elective Assembly seats, higher is the virtue of vote of each MLA of that State.**
3. **The value of vote of each MLA of Madhya Pradesh is greater than that of Kerala.**
4. **The value of vote of each MLA of Puducherry is higher than that of Arunachal Pradesh because the ratio of total population to total number of elective seats in Puducherry is greater as compared to Arunachal Pradesh.**

How many of the above statements are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) Only three (d) All four

Ans. (a) : The electoral college for election of President includes elected members of Parliament and state legislative assemblies. Thus statement I is incorrect.
The value of vote of each MLA depends on the ratio of the state is population and the number of MLAs in its legislative assembly and not just on number of elected seats. Thus statement II is incorrect.
The value of vote of each MLA of Madhya Pradesh is less than that of vote value of each MLA of Kerala. Thus statement III is incorrect.
The vote value of each MLA of Puducherry is higher than that of Arunachal Pradesh. Thus statement IV is correct.